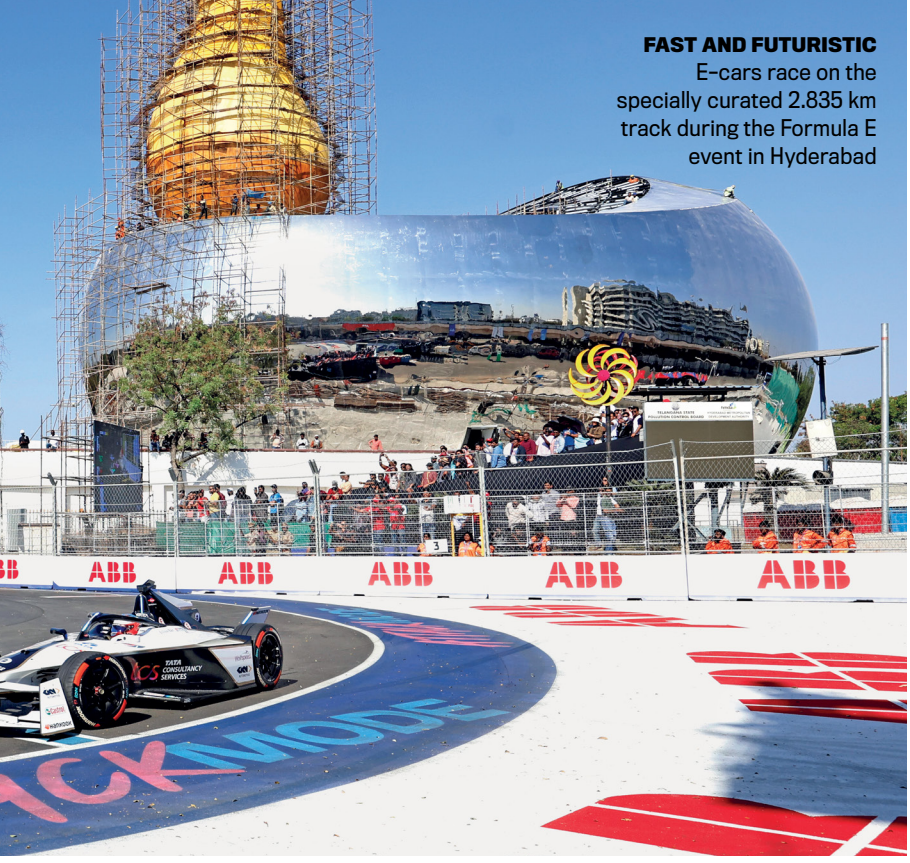


FAST AND FUTURISTIC
E-cars race on the specially curated 2.835 km track during the Formula E event in Hyderabad

AP

steps towards refining lithium.

Developing a policy for e-mobility is crucial to Telangana's attractiveness as an investment destination for the EV sector. The state is already home to several EV players and intends to leverage its strengths in the automotive, electronics, aerospace, defence and information technology sectors to create synergies and become a centre for research and innovation in EV, battery technologies and other emerging tech such as autonomous and connected vehicles. At present, the lack of charging infrastructure, along with the higher costs of the vehicles, range anxiety and innovation in battery storage capacity are among the major hurdles.

Telangana's Electric Vehicle and Energy Storage Systems Policy 2020-2030 intends to achieve a substantial reduction in the total cost of transportation for personal and commercial purposes, building on the foundation laid down by the central government's Faster Adoption and Manufacturing of Hybrid and Electrical Vehicles (FAME) II scheme. The policy aims to attract private investments worth $4 billion in the EV sector and create employment for 120,000 people by 2030. In the past two years, about 45,000 electric two-wheelers, 5,000 cars and 3,000 three-wheelers have been sold in Telangana. A fleet of 40 electric buses plies through five different routes connecting the airport with the city.

Telangana is home to leading Indian and global EV companies such as Mahindra & Mahindra (M&M), Olectra, ZF, Mytrah, Gravton, Hyundai Mobis, One Moto and Pure EV. Citroen, Quantum Energy and Hop Electric are new EV offerings. M&M, the first Indian automobile maker to develop an e-race car (Mahindra XUV 400 EV), is investing Rs 1,000 crore in expanding its facility at Zaheerabad to make electric three- and four-wheelers. "Last-mile mobility is growing fastest in the EV space and so we are rapidly setting up capacity to accelerate the growth of sustainable mobility in the country," says Rajesh Jejurikar, executive director (auto and farm), M&M. It is collaborating with the state government in laying the roadmap for the development of EVs and energy storage systems manufacturing units. Zaheerabad is one of the four mega EV manufacturing clusters being developed by the state.

AN E-MOBILITY POLICY IS CRUCIAL TO TELANGANA'S ATTRACTIVENESS FOR THE EV SECTOR PLAYERS

Amara Raja Batteries Ltd (ARBL) will put Rs 9,500 crore in a lithium-ion battery manufacturing giga corridor to catalyse the evolution of a comprehensive EV and advanced chemistry cell ecosystem. The Andhra Pradesh-based battery-maker will set up an advanced energy and research centre—Amara Raja E-Hub—near the airport and other facilities at Divitapally in Mahabubnagar district. "The e-hub will have advanced laboratories and testing infrastructure for material research and prototyping not just for ARBL needs but also for other players in the energy and mobility ecosystem," says Jayadev Galla, industrialist-politician and CMD.

To improve awareness of the advantages of going electric, the Telangana government has conducted multiple road shows, EV expos and conferences. The state has also set aggressive targets in clean energy production, which complement the EV charging infrastructure. The role of the Telangana State Renewable Energy Development Corporation, a nodal agency for implementing EV infrastructure, will be crucial: it's setting up 1,000 EV charging stations across the state under the PPP model.

India's first new mobility-focused cluster, Telangana Mobility Valley (TMV), was announced at the first edition of Mobility Next Hyderabad Summit—part of the Hyderabad E-Mobility Week (February 5-11). TMV aims to attract investments of around Rs 50,000 crore and generate over 400,000 jobs in the next five years. "With zero or ultra-low tailpipe emissions of pollutants, e-mobility proves to be a big stepping stone for India's vision to reach net-zero carbon emission by 2070," said Jayesh Ranjan, principal secretary, Industries and Commerce and Information Technology, Telangana. India is gradually vrooming towards an EV revolution, with Telangana at the wheel. ■